A-A-20252
April 7, 1997

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

PLUM (PRUNE) PUREE, DRIED

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

1. SCOPE.

1.1 This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers dried plum (prune) puree, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by the Federal Government.

2. CLASSIFICATION.

Type of pack.

Type I - No. 10 can
Type II - 2-gallon plastic pails
Type III - 55-pound plastic pails

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 **Processing:** The dried plum (prune) puree shall be obtained from wholesome dried plums (prunes) and prune juice concentrate, and be prepared in accordance with good commercial practice.

3.2 **Flavor and odor:** The finished product shall have a mild fruity flavor and odor typical of plum/prune puree.

3.3 **Color:** The finished dried plum (prune) puree shall have a dark brown color typical of dried plum (prune) puree.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Head, Food Quality Assurance Staff, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Ave., SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243 or telephone (202) 720-9939 or FAX (202) 690-0102.

FSC 8915

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3.4 **Consistency:** The finished dried plum (prune) puree shall be a lump-free pliable paste, thick and smooth and free from pit fragments.

3.5 **Age requirement:** Unless otherwise specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, dried plum (prune) puree shall be prepared from dried plums (prunes) and prune juice concentrate from the latest year's crop, and shall be processed and packaged less than one year prior to purchase by the Government.

3.6 **Additives or preservatives:** The dried plum (prune) puree shall be processed with no additives or preservatives (other than potassium sorbate or sorbic acid).

3.7 **Shelf life:** The manufacturer shall guarantee a minimum shelf life for the dried plum (prune) puree of 9 months from the date of delivery.

3.8 **Analytical requirements:** Unless otherwise specified, analytical requirements for dried plum (prune) puree shall be as follows:

Brix	Minimum °Brix of 70
Moisture	30 percent ± 0.5 percent
pH	3.15 - 3.94, maximum 4.0

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.

4.1 The delivered dried plum (prune) puree shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the dried plum (prune) puree within the commercial marketplace. Delivered dried plum (prune) puree shall comply with all applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

5.1 **Product conformance.** The dried plum (prune) puree provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this CID, conform to the producer's own specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same dried plum (prune) puree offered for sale in the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 **Quality assurance.** When the solicitation, contract, or purchase order requires that dried plum (prune) puree quality or acceptability or both be determined, the Processed Products Branch (PPB), Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, shall be the certifying activity and shall make the determination in accordance with applicable PPB procedures. The dried plum (prune) puree shall be examined

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or analyzed or both in accordance with applicable provisions in the CID, and when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers.

6. PACKAGING.

6.1 Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking shall be as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

7. NOTES.

7.1 It has been found that the following formulation provides acceptable product when dried.

Dried plums (prunes)	17.2 percent (Solids)
Prune juice concentrate	52.7 percent (Solids)
Potassium sorbate or sorbic acid	0.1 percent maximum
Water	30 percent 1/

1/ The actual amount of water added is based on the moisture content of the dried plum (prune) puree.

7.2 Sources of documents.

7.2.1 Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. This document may be purchased from: **Superintendent of Documents, ATTN: New Orders, P.O. Box 371954, Pittsburgh, PA 15250-7954.** Credit card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 512-1800.

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from: **Chairperson, Condition of Container Committee, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Avenue, SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243.**

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from: **General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Specifications Section, Suite 8100, 470 East L'Enfant Plaza, SW, Washington, DC 20407.**

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CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - NIH, IHS
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

USDA - FV

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